Business Model — The Citadel

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The Citadel: Skills that get you in

We earn from courses first, then from partner organisations as the talent pool grows. Learning starts free and stays cheap: the first 25% of every paid course is free, and applying for internships is always free.

Value: a trusted path for learners, proven talent for companies.

Courses and instructors

We produce our own courses, and one instructor teaches each course. Partner companies set the final challenge, and AI helps produce lessons faster. Every course is reviewed by an expert before launch.

Where we find instructors

- **Team network:** senior developers and designers we already know.
- **LinkedIn and local tech groups:** experienced IT people in Myanmar.
- **Partner companies:** their senior staff teach the track their company sponsors.
- **Top learners later:** learners who land jobs come back as mentors.

How we produce courses

- **Short format:** small video lessons plus practice tasks, quick to record and update.
- **AI support:** AI drafts outlines, quizzes and practice tasks, and adds Burmese subtitles and summaries; an expert reviews everything.
- **Free resources linked, not copied:** official docs and trusted free learning sites.
- **Quality checks:** expert review before launch, learner ratings per lesson, partner check that skills match real jobs.

How we pay instructors

Model	How it works	When we use it
Revenue share	Instructor gets [__]% of each sale of their course	Main model from the start

Model	How it works	When we use it
Small upfront fee	One-time payment to create a course	First 2–3 instructors, to get started
Partner-paid	Partner company's own staff teach its sponsored track	When a company sponsors a track

Beyond money, instructors get a featured profile, early access to talented learners they may hire, and teaching experience.

Courses and learners

Learners start free, pay for full tracks, and never pay to apply for an internship.

Course tracks

Track	Entry role	Example partner challenge
Career starter (free)	Any track	Set a career goal, learn basic AI tools, get a roadmap
Frontend web development	Junior frontend developer	Build a responsive page from a company's design
UI/UX design	Junior UI/UX designer	Redesign one app screen and explain the choices
QA / software testing	QA tester intern	Find and report bugs in a test app
Data analysis	Junior data analyst	Clean a dataset and answer three business questions
Digital marketing with AI tools	Marketing intern	Plan a one-week social media campaign

Demo track: frontend web development. Confirm which roles partners hire for before building more tracks.

What learners pay for

- **Free:** Career starter course, the first 25% of every paid course, applying for internships.
- **Paid tracks:** the other 75% of each full course track, priced at or below local rates (Futura School charges 30,000–600,000 MMK per course).

- **Later:** 1:1 mentor sessions, paid per session (see Mentors, later).

Free and paid, suggested split

What	Free	Paid track
Career starter course	All lessons, quizzes, AI notes and a certificate	n/a
First 25% of each paid course	Lessons, quizzes, AI notes and summaries	n/a
Last 75% of each paid course	Locked	Lessons, quizzes, AI notes and summaries, own notes
Final test and certificate	Career starter only	Included in the track price
Company challenge	Locked until the course is done	Included, no extra charge
Internship application and interview	Always free	Always free
Community	Free for everyone	Free for everyone
Mentor sessions	Later	Paid per session

What learners get

- A clear roadmap to an entry-level IT job.
- Short lessons of 4–6 weeks per track, with AI notes and summaries.
- Proof of skill from a real company challenge, saved to their profile.
- An internship interview when they pass.

Rules that protect learners

- Never charge for challenges, applications or interviews.
- Only verified partner companies can post opportunities.

Organisations and registration

Companies register, get verified, then pay for what they use: challenges, candidates and hires. The first partners join free.

Who we register

IT companies, software houses and outsourcing firms, tech startups and digital agencies in Myanmar. Confirm with the companies we can reach.

How registration works

1. **Apply:** the company fills in a short registration form.
2. **Verify:** we check business registration, a real office and contact on its own domain, its online presence, and hold a short call.
3. **Agree terms:** internship role, duration, location and any stipend are written down; the company agrees never to charge learners or hold their passport or ID.
4. **Go live:** the company gets a "Verified" badge and can post challenges and internships.
5. **Stay trusted:** learner ratings, a Report button and a yearly re-check.

What partners get

- Pre-screened young talent who passed the company's own challenge.
- Lower hiring cost: fewer job ads, less screening, fewer interviews.
- Courses shaped to the skills they hire for.
- Employer branding through sponsored tracks.

What partners pay, by stage

Stage	What they pay	Why
Launch: first 2–3 partners	Free or discounted	We need partners more than their money at first
Growth	Partner fee (monthly or yearly) to post challenges, see candidates and post internships	Charges for value, not just for signing up
Growth	Hiring fee each time they take on an intern or hire	Grows with our success
Optional	Sponsored track fee	Brand plus talent trained in their skills

Community

Learners and companies talk in one shared community inside the web app. It is free for everyone, and it makes learners stay and companies stay visible.

First version

- **Course discussion:** learners ask and answer questions under each course.
- **Challenge Q&A:** learners ask a company about a challenge, and the verified company replies.

Rules

- Only verified companies can post as a company.
- Every post has a Report button.
- No sharing of challenge answers.
- No private contact details in posts.

Later

- Study groups, online meetups and success stories.
- Featured event promotion for event organisers, once traffic grows.

Cost

Our team moderates reports and events. This is a small running cost, to be checked.

Mentors (later)

Not in the first version. We price mentor sessions the way ADPList does:

- A mentor can offer free or paid sessions.
- Our platform fee is a flat 10% taken from the mentor's price, with no other fees.
- The mentor is paid after the session is completed, through a local mobile wallet.
- Mentors come from industry instructors and, later, learners who landed jobs.

Revenue at a glance

Earning point	Paid by	Starts
Paid course tracks	Learners	Launch
Mentor session fee (10% of each session)	Mentors	Later
Partner fee	Organisations	Growth
Hiring fee	Organisations	Growth

Earning point	Paid by	Starts
Sponsored tracks	Organisations	Growth
Education ads (light)	Advertisers	Later, optional

Why it lasts: free learning brings more young people, more tested talent brings more companies, and more companies bring more challenges and internships. Courses earn from day one; company fees grow with the platform.

Never: charge learners to apply for internships or get an interview.

Open question: exact prices. Ask 2–3 companies what they spend on hiring an intern today, and test course prices with learners.